

If you are under 18 years old, you will also need to:

- Be at least 15½ years old.
- Complete a driver education program.
- Have a parent or guardian sign to approve the application and accept financial responsibility (see Section 10). If your parents or guardians share joint custody of you, both must sign.
- Wait to use your instruction permit until you start behind-the-wheel driver training with an instructor who will validate the permit.

DRIVING SCHOOLS

Driver education and driver training are offered at DMV-licensed driving schools and some high schools. Instructors must carry an instructor's ID card. Ask to see it.

See the Driver Training Schools page at dmv.ca.gov/driver-ed for more information about selecting a driving school.

APPLYING FOR A DRIVER'S LICENSE

To get your driver's license after you have your instruction permit, you need to:

- Practice driving with a California-licensed driver who is at least 18 years old (25 for minors). This person must sit close enough to take control of the vehicle if needed.
- Pass a behind-the-wheel drive test.

If you are under 18 years old, you will also need to:

- Be at least 16 years old.
- Have an instruction permit from California or another state for at least 6 months (or turn 18 years old) before scheduling your behind-the-wheel drive test.
- Prove that you completed **both** driver education and driver training.
- Practice driving for at least 50 hours with a California-licensed driver who is at least 25 years old. Ten hours must be at night.

See the Driver's Licenses page at dmv.ca.gov/teendriver for the complete list of application steps, requirements, the Parent Teen Driving Contract, and Driving Performance Evaluation (DPE) Score Sheet.